06 Nov 2026 06:50:12 ET | 14 pages

PharmaResearch (214450.KQ)

In-line 3Q26, two positive catalysts lie ahead in FY27E

CITI'S TAKE

PharmaResearch (PR) recorded sales of W172bn (+27% YoY) and OP of W66bn (+27% YoY), which came in line with our estimates. For 2027E, we believe the OP margin outlook should be revised down from its current 40% OP margin to 37% levels. However, we expect two positive catalysts await in FY27E – Rejuran domestic sales growth acceleration and Brazil market entry. Reiterate Buy with TP of W450k.

In-line 3Q26 — PharmaResearch recorded sales of W172bn (+27% YoY) and OP of W66bn (+27% YoY), which came in line with our estimates. Medical device recorded W87bn (+13% YoY) on back of solid overseas export growth (W30bn, +50% YoY) from existing countries offsetting flat Korea (W57bn) sales. Cosmetics recorded W62bn (+76% YoY) as PR continues to expand into new overseas channels (Costco, Ulta, etc). OP margin recorded W37% (-70bnps QoQ) from unfavorable sales mix (due to increased cosmetic portion of 36% vs. 34% QoQ) and one-off CG USA acquisition cost (W2bn).

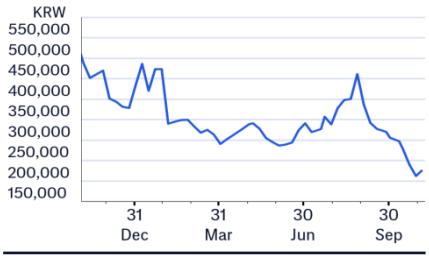
Two positive catalysts in FY27E — For 2027E, we believe the OP margin outlook should be revised down from current 40% OP margin to 37% levels due to 1) sales mix shift to cosmetics; 2) drag from loss-making USA ODM plant and 3) 2nd toxin plant utilization, which should start from 2H27E. However, **we expect two positive catalysts await in FY27E**: 1) domestic sales growth acceleration driven by synergy with the EBD device to be launched within 1Q27E, 2) Rejuran medical device's Brazil entry expected from 2H27E (CitiE 4bn in year 1) along with continued growth for Western Europe. Therefore, we see FY27E revenue of W850bn (+25% YoY) and OP of W318bn (+26% YoY, OP margin 37.4%). In the next 2-3 years, we would also highlight that cosmetics underlying margin should improve on the back of logistics cost efficiency via CG USA.

Reiterate Buy — We revise up our FY26-27E NP estimates by 1-3% on back of continued solid topline growth momentum. We continue to have a positive view on the stock, given that fundamentals continue to be solid with medical device sales growth, in addition to strong cosmetics execution. Despite market concerns on medical device domestic competition and slower than expected export sales growth, we see PR's strategy to accelerate domestic sales growth and new market entry opportunities posing upside risk for the stock. Reiterate Buy with unchanged TP of W450k.

Buy

Price (06 Nov 26 15:45)	W234,500
Target price	W450,000
Expected share price return	91.9%
Expected dividend yield	1.7%
Expected total return	93.6%
Market Cap	W2,436,372M
	US$1,794M

Price Performance
(RIC: 214450.KQ, BB: 214450 KS)



Heejin Lim AC

Earnings Summary

Year to 31 Dec	Net Profit (WB)	Diluted EPS (W)	EPS growth (%)	P/E (x)	P/B (x)	ROE (%)	Yield (%)
2024A	92	8,838	17.9	26.5	4.6	18.9	0.5
2025A	165	15,801	78.8	14.8	3.5	26.9	1.6
2026E	212	18,368	16.2	12.8	2.8	27.3	1.7
2027E	244	21,103	14.9	11.1	2.3	25.2	1.7
2028E	300	25,926	22.9	9.0	1.8	25.0	1.7

Source: Powered by dataCentral

See Appendix A-1 for Analyst Certification, Important Disclosures and Research Analyst Affiliations.

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214450.KQ: Fiscal year end 31-Dec						Price: W234,500; TP: W450,000; Market Cap: W2,436,372m; Recomm: Buy					
Profit & Loss (Wb)	**2024**	**2025**	**2026E**	**2027E**	**2028E**	**Valuation ratios**	**2024**	**2025**	**2026E**	**2027E**	**2028E**
Sales revenue	350	536	680	850	1,018	PE (x)	26.5	14.8	12.8	11.1	9.0
Cost of sales	-99	-125	-161	-213	-252	PB (x)	4.6	3.5	2.8	2.3	1.8
Gross profit	251	411	519	636	766	EV/EBITDA (x)	15.6	8.3	6.6	4.9	3.7
Gross Margin (%)	71.8	76.7	76.3	74.9	75.2	FCF yield (%)	4.2	6.3	4.7	7.2	9.5
EBITDA (Adj)	**135**	**230**	**270**	**334**	**396**	Dividend yield (%)	0.5	1.6	1.7	1.7	1.7
EBITDA Margin (Adj) (%)	38.6	42.9	39.7	39.4	38.9	Payout ratio (%)	12	23	22	19	15
Depreciation	-9	-10	-9	-10	-11	ROE (%)	18.9	26.9	27.3	25.2	25.0
Amortisation	0	0	0	0	0	**Cashflow (Wb)**	**2024**	**2025**	**2026E**	**2027E**	**2028E**
EBIT (Adj)	**126**	**214**	**253**	**315**	**385**	EBITDA	135	224	262	325	396
EBIT Margin (Adj) (%)	36.0	40.0	37.2	37.0	37.8	Working capital	0	-25	-27	-43	-36
Net interest	-16	9	32	13	17	Other	3	-17	-85	-51	-62
Associates	6	0	0	0	0	**Operating cashflow**	**138**	**183**	**150**	**230**	**298**
Non-Op/Except/Other Adj	0	-7	0	0	0	Capex	-36	-30	-24	-34	-41
Pre-tax profit	**116**	**217**	**285**	**327**	**402**	Net acq/disposals	-170	-113	-7	-9	-12
Tax	-27	-48	-68	-79	-96	Other	-20	-13	0	0	0
Extraord./Min.Int./Pref.div.	3	-3	-4	-5	-6	**Investing cashflow**	**-226**	**-156**	**-31**	**-43**	**-53**
Reported net profit	**92**	**165**	**212**	**244**	**300**	Dividends paid	-10	-12	-39	-42	-49
Net Margin (%)	26.3	30.8	31.2	28.7	29.5	**Financing cashflow**	**183**	**-15**	**-39**	**-42**	**-49**
Core NPAT	92	165	212	244	300	**Net change in cash**	**96**	**10**	**81**	**144**	**197**
Per share data	**2024**	**2025**	**2026E**	**2027E**	**2028E**	**Free cashflow to s/holders**	**102**	**153**	**126**	**196**	**258**
Reported EPS (W)	8,838	15,801	18,368	21,103	25,926						
Core EPS (W)	8,838	15,801	18,368	21,103	25,926						
DPS (W)	1,100	3,700	4,000	4,000	4,000						
CFPS (W)	13,262	17,527	12,966	19,869	25,802						
FCFPS (W)	9,765	14,683	10,907	16,931	22,282						
BVPS (W)	51,323	66,346	83,459	103,306	128,015						
Wtd avg ord shares (m)	10.4	10.5	10.4	10.4	10.4						
Wtd avg diluted shares (m)	10.4	10.5	11.6	11.6	11.6						
Growth rates	**2024**	**2025**	**2026E**	**2027E**	**2028E**						
Sales revenue (%)	34.1	53.2	26.9	24.8	19.8						
EBIT (Adj) (%)	36.6	70.1	18.1	24.2	22.4						
Core NPAT (%)	20.2	79.4	28.7	14.9	22.9						
Core EPS (%)	17.9	78.8	16.2	14.9	22.9						
Balance Sheet (Wb)	**2024**	**2025**	**2026E**	**2027E**	**2028E**						
Cash & cash equiv.	452	620	762	906	1,102						
Accounts receivables	43	52	60	75	91						
Inventory	57	83	106	140	164						
Net fixed & other tangibles	200	235	247	266	290						
Goodwill & intangibles	33	31	33	38	44						
Financial & other assets	70	22	22	22	22						
Total assets	**856**	**1,044**	**1,231**	**1,447**	**1,714**						
Accounts payable	11	11	15	20	23						
Short-term debt	9	8	8	8	8						
Long-term debt	1	0	0	0	0						
Provisions & other liab	265	300	302	302	303						
Total liabilities	**286**	**320**	**325**	**330**	**335**						
Shareholders' equity	539	689	867	1,073	1,330						
Minority interests	30	35	39	43	49						
Total equity	**569**	**724**	**906**	**1,117**	**1,379**						
Net debt (Adj)	**-442**	**-612**	**-753**	**-897**	**-1,094**						
Net debt to equity (Adj) (%)	-77.6	-84.5	-83.2	-80.3	-79.3						

For definitions of the items in this table, please click here.

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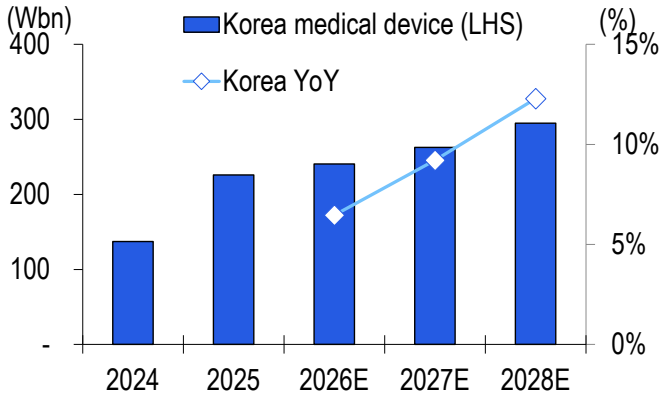
Figure 1. PR: 3Q26 Results Review

(Wbn)	3Q25	4Q25	1Q26	2Q26	3Q26P	YoY	QoQ	3Q26E Citi	Diff	3Q26E Cons	Diff
Revenue	**135**	**143**	**146**	**179**	**172**	**27%**	**-4%**	**172**	**0%**	**177**	**-3%**
YoY	52%	39%	25%	27%	27%			27%			
1) By segment											
Medical device (Skinbooster)	77	83	80	97	87	13%	-10%	90	-4%		
Cosmetics	35	38	42	60	62	76%	3%	59	6%		
Pharmaceuticals	22	23	21	18	19	-12%	5%	21	-6%		
Others	2	(1)	3	3	3	106%	-10%	3	15%		
2) By geography											
Domestic	85	85	88	95	91	6%	-5%	92	-2%		
Exports	50	58	58	83	81	61%	-3%	80	1%		
Asia	33	37	34	45	50	52%	10%	46	7%		
> China	18	18	-	-	-			-			
> Asia ex-China	15	19	-	-	-			-			
EU/Oceania	7	12	9	20	13	89%	-32%	16	-16%		
America	10	9	13	17	16	71%	-5%	20	-19%		
Others	1	1	2	2	2	79%	4%	3	-34%		
Operating profit	**62**	**52**	**57**	**66**	**63**	**1%**	**-6%**	**62**	**1%**	**71**	**-11%**
OPM	46%	36%	39%	37%	37%			36%		40%	
YoY	77%	54%	28%	19%	1%			0%			
RP	**65**	**50**	**68**	**74**	**44**	**-32%**	**-40%**	**65**	**-32%**	**71**	**-38%**
Ex-minority NP	**49**	**33**	**48**	**57**	**30**	**-39%**	**-47%**	**48**	**-38%**	**57**	**-47%**

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Source: Citi Research

Figure 2. PR: Domestic medical device sales outlook



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Figure 3. PR: 4Q26 Results Preview

(Wbn)	4Q25	1Q26	2Q26	3Q26P	4Q26E	YoY	QoQ	4Q26E Cons	Diff
Revenue	**143**	**146**	**179**	**172**	**184**	**28%**	**7%**	**191**	**-4%**
YoY	39%	25%	27%	27%	28%				
1) By segment									
Medical device (Skinbooster)	83	80	97	87	93	12%	7%		
Cosmetics	38	42	60	62	67	78%	8%		
Pharmaceuticals	23	21	18	19	20	-11%	5%		
Others	(1)	3	3	3	3	N/A	10%		
2) By geography									
Domestic	85	88	95	91	93	10%	3%		
Exports	58	58	83	81	91	56%	12%		
Asia	37	34	45	50	51	38%	3%		
> China	18	-	-	-	-				
> Asia ex-China	19	-	-	-	-				
EU/Oceania	12	9	20	13	17	43%	26%		
America	9	13	17	16	22	150%	35%		
Others	1	2	2	2	1	21%	-21%		
	0	0	0	0	0				
Operating profit	**52**	**57**	**66**	**63**	**66**	**26%**	**5%**	**74**	**-11%**
OPM	36.2%	39.2%	37.2%	36.5%	35.7%			38.6%	
YoY	54.1%	28.1%	19.0%	1.2%	26.5%				
RP	**50**	**68**	**74**	**44**	**69**	**37%**	**55%**	**77**	**-11%**
Ex-minority NP	**33**	**48**	**57**	**30**	**50**	**54%**	**68%**	**60**	**-17%**

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Source: Citi Research, Company Reports, Bloomberg

Figure 4. PR: Earnings Revision

(W bn, %)	New			Old			%		
	2026E	2027E	2028E	2026E	2027E	2028E	2026E	2027E	2028E
Revenue	680	850	1,018	682	820	973	0%	4%	5%
OP	253	315	385	251	311	379	1%	1%	2%
RP	285	327	402	282	323	396	1%	1%	2%
NP	212	244	300	210	241	295	1%	1%	2%
OPM	37.2%	37.0%	37.8%	36.8%	37.9%	38.9%	0.5%pt	-0.8%pt	-1.1%pt
RPM	41.9%	38.5%	39.5%	41.4%	39.4%	40.7%	0.5%pt	-0.9%pt	-1.2%pt
NPM	31.2%	28.7%	29.5%	30.9%	29.4%	30.4%	0.4%pt	-0.7%pt	-0.9%pt

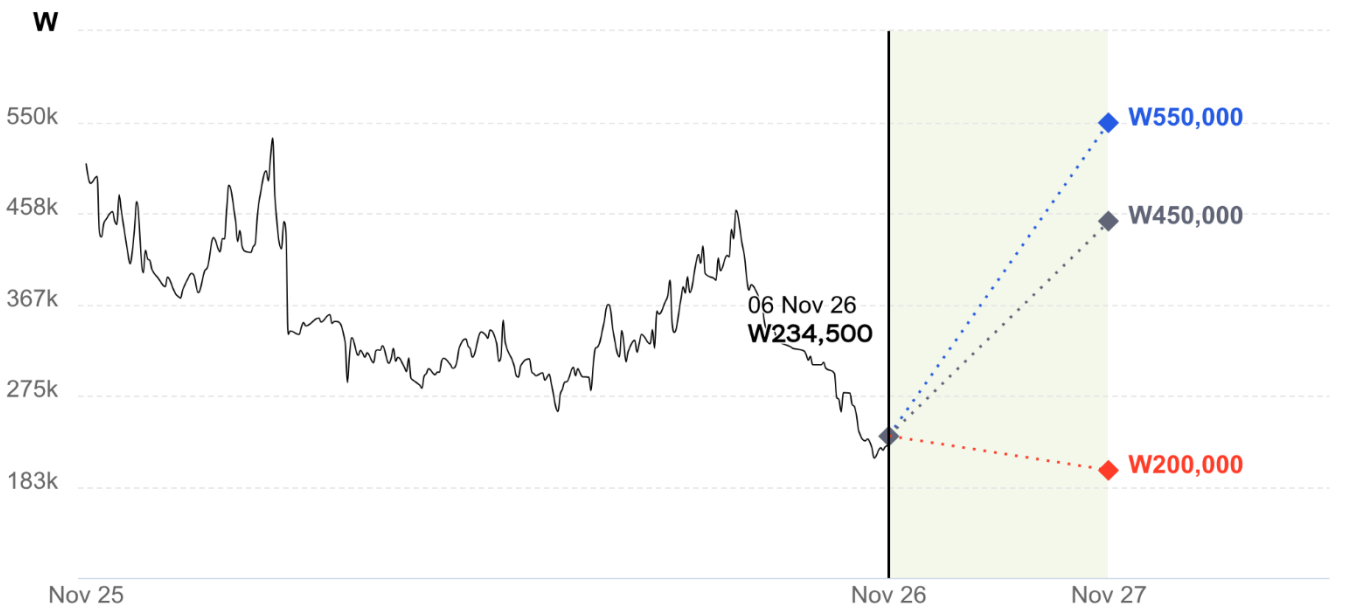
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Source: Citi Research, Company Reports, Bloomberg

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Bull/Bear: PharmaResearch (214450.KQ)

W 550,000	W 450,000	W 200,000
▲135% Upside	▲92% Upside	▼15% Downside



Spread 149pp
Current Price and expected returns (upside/downside) as of 06 Nov 2026

BULL Assumptions

- Stronger-than-expected sales growth in medical device
- Higher-than-expected demand for cosmetics
- Better cost control management leading to higher margin profile

BASE Assumptions

- Medical device sales growth of +16% YoY in FY27E
- Cosmetics sales growth of +46% YoY in FY27E
- OP margin of 37% in FY27E

BEAR Assumptions

- Weaker-than-expected sales growth in medical device
- Lower-than-expected demand for cosmetics
- Less effective cost control management leading to lower margin profile

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PharmaResearch

Company description

PharmaResearch, founded in 2001, is a leading South Korean medical aesthetics/pharmaceutical company specializing in regenerative materials based on polynucleotide (PN)/polydeoxyribonucleotide (PDRN) ingredients. Its major products include facial injectable medical device Rejuran and arthritis joint cavity injection product Conjuran, followed by derivative value-added cosmetic products under the same Rejuran brand.

Investment strategy

We have a Buy rating on PharmaResearch, a leading company in the global medical aesthetics sector, underpinned by its regenerative PN/PDRN skin booster. Our investment thesis assumes: 1) solid topline growth potential in the domestic market from inbound tourism; 2) increasing penetration in EU/US markets backed by rising brand recognition; and 3) portfolio expansion into toxin, new collagen booster, and EBD providing additional catalysts.

Valuation

Our target price of W450k is based on a P/E methodology. We believe PR is set for strong growth momentum underpinned by: 1) full reflection of the EU market expansion; 2) increase in cosmetic penetration in the US; and 3) sustained growth across existing countries. We believe our target 2027E P/E multiple of 20x is based on 3-year historical average PE multiple. We believe such multiple is justified , given 1) brand originality, which many local peers seem to lack, supporting competitiveness and longer product lifecycle; 2) stronger growth potential relative to top-tier peer's injectable aesthetics sales outlook; and 3) earnings upside risk from skinbooster TAM opportunities.

Risks

Key downside risks that could impede the shares from reaching our target price include: 1) change in trend (or increase in competition) within skin boosters; 2) brand reputation risk in case of medical incidents; 3) rise of generics / competition post-Rejuran's patent expiry after 2030E; and 4) prolonged weak growth in overseas markets.

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Appendix A-1

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IMPORTANT DISCLOSURES

PharmaResearch (214450.KQ)

Ratings and Target Price History
Fundamental Research

Analyst: Heejin Lim



	Date	Rating	Target Price	Closing Price
1	19-May-25 04:55:14	*1H	*560,000.00	422,500.00
2	16-Jun-25 02:31:23	1H	*540,000.00	458,000.00
3	08-Jul-25 10:31:21	*1	*710,000.00	588,000.00
4	10-Aug-25 17:24:44	1	*800,000.00	664,000.00
5	11-Nov-25 11:50:03	1	*650,000.00	440,000.00
6	04-Feb-26 11:41:01	1	*570,000.00	439,500.00
7	30-Apr-26 13:47:42	1	*480,000.00	313,500.00
8	07-Aug-26 11:15:44	1	*500,000.00	378,500.00
9	27-Oct-26 07:03:44	1	*450,000.00	231,500.00

*Indicates Change

Rating/target price changes above reflect Eastern Time

PharmaResearch (214450.KQ)

Short-Term View/Catalyst Watch Research

Analyst: Heejin Lim



	Date	Action	Expected Direction	Duration	Closing Price
1	04-Feb-26 06:41:01	Add STV	Downside	30 Days	439,500.00
2	06-Mar-26 12:23:25	Remove STV	Downside	30 Days	333,000.00
3	07-Aug-26 07:15:44	Add STV	Upside	90 Days	378,500.00
4	27-Oct-26 03:03:44	Remove STV	Upside	90 Days	231,500.00

CW - Catalyst Watch , STV - Short-Term View

Rating/target price changes above reflect Eastern Time

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	12 Month Rating			Catalyst Watch		
Data current as of 01 Oct 2026	**Buy**	**Hold**	**Sell**	**Buy**	**Hold**	**Sell**
Citi Research Global Fundamental Coverage (Neutral=Hold)	61%	32%	7%	36%	48%	16%
% of companies in each rating category that are investment banking clients	39%	43%	30%	42%	38%	36%

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